Northwind Robotics

Picking arms for small warehouses

Seed round · October 2026

PROBLEM

Small warehouses can't hire pickers, and robots were built for giants.

Pickers are scarce

Seasonal peaks mean overtime, temps and missed cutoffs.

Automation is all-or-nothing

Existing systems need a new building, a long install and a big budget.

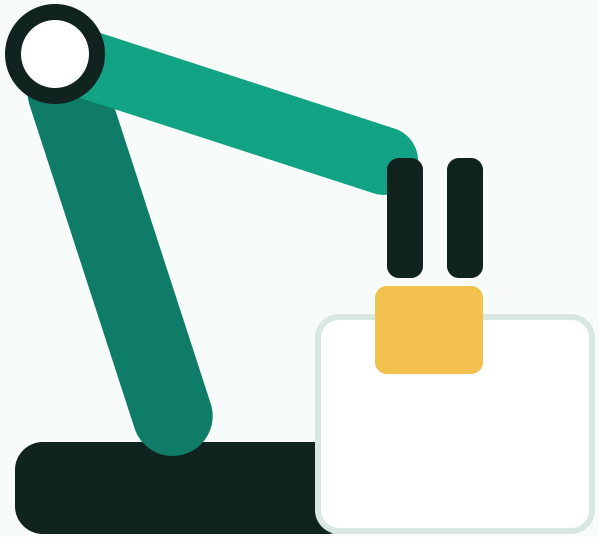
Small sites are left out

Most warehouses are small and run on shelving that robots weren't designed for.

PRODUCT

A picking arm that drops into existing shelving.

Bolts onto a standard cart, learns the pick face in an afternoon and works alongside people. No new building, no ripping out racking.



TRACTION

$400K

$400K ARR from 3 customers: Contoso, Fabrikam, Tailspin.

Contoso	Fabrikam	Tailspin

BUSINESS MODEL

Robots as a service: a monthly fee per arm, with no upfront cost.

Pilot

One arm on the hardest pick zone

Expand

More arms across the same site

Multi-site

Roll out to every building

Software

Fleet analytics as an add-on

TEAM

An 8-person team of roboticists and warehouse operators.

PS

Priya Shah

CEO · robotics, ex-warehouse automation

DK

Daniel Kowalski

CTO · manipulation and perception

AR

Ana Ruiz

Head of Operations · ran fulfilment sites

LT

Leo Tan

Lead engineer · embedded systems

FINANCING

$2.5M pre-seed (March 2026).

The pre-seed took us from prototype to paying customers. Every customer started with a pilot and converted to a paid contract.

Prototype

First arm picking from a standard shelf

First pilot

Running nightly shifts at a customer site

Paid contracts

Every pilot converted

Seed

Manufacturing and a sales team

THE ASK

Raising a $6M seed to put arms in more small warehouses.

Manufacturing

Move from hand-built to a contract manufacturer

Sales

First sales team for regional 3PLs

Software

Faster setup for new pick faces

Support

Field technicians in two regions

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